Her heart hammered and her chest burned. The sense of danger was so overwhelming her mind went blank. She reached the opened hatch and slipped inside. She could hear distant voices, shouts in German echoing with menace.

Rose closed the hatch. The voices grew muffled, like sinking underwater into darkness. She reached into her pocket for the key Léa had put there, her fingers trembling as she found the opening. She slipped the key inside, turned it clockwise until it clicked. Locked. She removed the key and exhaled.

And then, with a sudden piercing awareness, she realized that she was safe, but her sister wasn’t.